

U.S. History





About the Course

Read United States history stories from the current history cycle (1800-1900). View images and reference atlases and maps to set the people and events in their time and place. Update History Charts as appropriate for student level.

This topic is included in the following course(s): History: Grade 4 (U.S.), History: Grades 5-6 (U.S.)



Placement & Combining Tips

This course is the same for 4th-6th graders. In grade 5, students may begin their Book of Centuries.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
4-6	U.S. History: Grades 4-6 1 time/week 25 min	Heart and Soul: The Story of America and African Americans Children of the Wild West Lincoln: A Photobiography SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
History: Grade 4 (U.S.)				
	U.S. History: Grades 4-6		World History: Grades 4-6	
History: Grades 5-6 (U.S.)				
	U.S. History: Grades 4-6		World History: Grades 4-6	Ancient History: Grades 5-6



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

History: Grade 4 (U.S.)

☐ Read the document in the Quick Links about History Timelines and Charts.

☐ We encourage you to pick a biography for each term to read in the afternoons. The Bookshelf has many recommendations.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

U.S. History: Grades 4-6



Heart and Soul: The Story of America and African Americans



Children of the Wild West



Lincoln: A Photobiography



SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

U.S. History: Grades 4-6

- ∞ [Extra Helpings](#)
- ∞ [U.S. History: Grades 4-6 Student Lessons \(No Answers\)](#)

Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.



Related Course Quick Links

- ∞ [Grade 4 U.S. History Chart Prompts](#)
- ∞ [History Charts & Timeline Scope & Sample](#)
- ∞ [Century Chart](#)
- ∞ [Grade 5 U.S. History Chart Prompts](#)
- ∞ [Grade 6 U.S. History Chart Prompts](#)
- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 15: History\)](#)
- ∞ [History: Grade 4 \(U.S.\) Student Lessons \(No Answers\)](#)
- ∞ [History: Grades 5-6 \(U.S.\) Student Lessons \(No Answers\)](#)

U.S. History: Grades 4-6

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance.



Recap

- Connect to previous lessons by asking students to recall where they left off.
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture from the reading, sharing something the teacher remembers, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, teachers might consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading this time) or repeating the previous lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage out loud. When reading to pre-readers, point to the words as you read, even if it seems like they aren't paying attention.
- Move at the student's pace for the lesson time rather than a particular number of pages. It is vitally important that teachers not try to 'force feed' a student more than they can consume in one sitting.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally.
- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill requiring the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today. Notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they say about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they

are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note. If necessary, take a break for the day.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you could ask them what they thought about the passage or ask an open-ended question.

U.S. History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 1

A Duck, A Dog, and a Deal

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

→ PREP

1. Please note that a few of the chapters will be skipped for the sake of time. You can encourage your student to read those chapters outside of lesson time.
2. You may want to read the introduction to get some more background knowledge about the book.

→ INTRO

This year, we are studying the history of the United States from 1800-1900. President Thomas Jefferson acquired a large amount of land west of the Mississippi for \$15 million through the Louisiana Purchase from France. He chose Meriwether Lewis to head an expedition to explore this area. Along with William Clark and a select group of men, a dog named Seaman joined the expedition. We learn about this dog in the journals of Lewis and Clark. For a long time, people thought the name of the dog was Scannon because it was hard to read the handwriting. Over the years, more information about Seaman has been found in the journals and other sources. That is what makes the study of history interesting—historians continue to find more evidence that adds to a fuller understanding of the past. The author wrote this story based on Lewis and Clark's journals, which were originally written with a quill pen!

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Map at the back of the book

At the beginning of the book, Lewis is in Pittsburgh and then needs to meet Clark before heading to Fort Wood, where they will spend the winter before they begin their expedition. Trace this route on the map. What rivers will he be traveling along to get to the camp? [A: Ohio and Mississippi]

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-11 "The huge black" - "lift their spirits."

- One of the goals of the expedition was to look for the Northwest Passage. Many thought there would be a direct water route across the continent that led to the Pacific Ocean. It was believed that this waterway could open a direct trade route between North America and Asia. Lewis and Clark were to find out and let President Jefferson know. Do you know if there is a direct water route from the Atlantic to the Pacific? You can look at a map to find out.

→ VIEW

Look at the entry from Lewis's journal on p.9. What do you notice about the spelling? Spelling changes over time. You will notice different spellings in the other entries as well.

• EXTRA HELPING

If you have time, this is an interesting video that talks about the Louisiana Purchase and the reasons for the expedition.

∞ Video Link: Lewis and Clark Expedition Part 1

WEEK 2 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 2

Getting Ready

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO



Term 1

You have met Meriwether Lewis, who was President Jefferson's personal secretary and an officer in the United States Army. Now we will meet William Clark, a retired officer who had served alongside Lewis in the Army. He will be the expedition's co-leader. Here is a replica of the keelboat that was built for this expedition. It was 55 feet long (almost the length of a bowling alley) with room for about 20 men to row and more space for supplies.

∞ Image Link: Replica of keelboat

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Continue Ch.2 p.11-18 "Along the banks" - "of a dog."

- Why might a dog be a good companion for the expedition?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Statue of Lewis and Clark

This statue on the Ohio River in Clarksville, Indiana, marks the meeting place where the two explorers met.

WEEK 3 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 3

The Journey Begins

📄 Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ INTRO

Today, you will read about the men who were chosen to be in the Corps (pronounced /kor/) of Discovery. What kind of skills do you think would be helpful for these men to have?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.18-27 "On November 20" - "a beautiful place."

→ VIEW

One of the goals of the expedition was to learn about plant and animal species and bring back samples. Here is a journal page that shows a drawing of a pheasant.

∞ Image Link: Journal Entry from Clark

• IMPORTANT DATES

1804 Lewis and Clark Expedition begins

WEEK 4 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 4

Sioux Territory

📄 Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

PREP: We are skipping chapter 4 for the sake of time. There will be a brief summary of it in the introduction.

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

1. We are skipping chapter 4, but one important incident to note is that Sergeant Charles Floyd developed serious stomach pains. Lewis gave him different medications that he had brought with him. However, Floyd died at the age of 22. They held a funeral service for him on a hill overlooking a river and named it "Sergeant Floyd's Bluff." Many people now think he had appendicitis.

2. Trace the route down the Missouri River to the place where Sergeant



Term 1

Floyd died.

📄 Map Resource: Map at the back of the book

3. Another goal of the expedition was to establish relations with Native Americans. In today's reading, Lewis and Clark will meet the Sioux who live in what is now South Dakota. This is what President Jefferson said to the explorers about the Sioux: "On that nation, we wish more particularly to make a friendly impression, because of their immense power, and because we learn they are very desirous of being on the most friendly terms with us." Let's see if they really do want to be on friendly terms with the Americans.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5 p.37-45 "On the twenty-seventh" - "Clark climbed aboard."

→ VIEW

Look at the journal entry on p.46. How did Clark show leadership in that situation?

WEEK 5 📅 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 5

Sioux Territory; Winter Among the Indians

📄 Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

→ RECAP

Where did we leave off last time?

→ INTRO

The Corps of Discovery will be meeting another tribe today, known as the Arikaras. Look at the map to see their location. What state did they live in?

∞ Map Link: Expedition Map

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.47-56 "As evening approached" - "understand each other."

→ VIEW

This is a picture of a reconstructed earth lodge that the Arikaras would have lived in.

∞ Image Link: Earth Lodge

WEEK 6 📅 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 6

Winter Among the Indians

📄 Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

In today's reading, you will meet a teenage girl who joined the expedition. She has become quite famous in history, and there are 16 statues in her honor around the U.S. You will have to keep reading to see how she helps the Corps of Discovery.

∞ Image Link: Sakakawea (another spelling of Sacagawea) Statue in U.S. Capitol

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.56-66 "The Corps began" - "of my life."

U.S. History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ VIEW

The Corps built Fort Mandan to stay in during the winter of 1804-1805.
∞ Image Link: Reconstructed Fort Mandan

WEEK 7 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 7

Perils in Paradise

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

PREP: Today's reading is a little longer. If a teacher reads it aloud, it should take around 18 minutes.

→ RECAP

Tell briefly what you read last time.

→ INTRO

If you were exploring the wilderness of North Dakota, what animals might you be afraid of? We will read about some animals that brought peril or danger to the Corps of Discovery.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7 p.67-77

→ VIEW

Read the journal excerpt on p.75. Seaman is mentioned in Lewis's journal!

• DEFINITIONS

artery: any of the vessels that carry blood from the heart through the body (p.74)

WEEK 8 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 8

Searching for the Shoshone

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

PREP: We are skipping chapter 8 for the sake of time. Feel free to have your student read it on their own.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last chapter?

→ INTRO

1. We are skipping chapter 8. In that chapter, Seaman is back to normal and chases a 2000-pound buffalo through the campsite. The Corps of Discovery came to a fork in the Missouri River and needed to decide which way to go. They decided to take the southern river and came across many waterfalls that Lewis described as "the grandest sight I ever beheld." The water was falling over a cliff more than 80 feet high. They would have to portage (carry their boats overland) around the waterfalls. To lighten their load, they stored some of their supplies in a cache or hiding place in the ground that they would get on their way back.
2. Find the Great Falls on the map. Now go along the route until you get to Three Forks. Continue on the route until you find where the Shoshone lived. The Corps of Discovery needed to find these people because they had something very valuable that the explorers needed.
∞ Map Link: Map of Expedition

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9 p.89-97 "Seaman splashed into" - "horses to trade!"

→ VIEW

This picture shows the headwaters (original source) of the Missouri River



Term 1

in Montana. This is the point where the three forks—the Jefferson, Gallatin, and Madison rivers—join as one, the great Missouri River.
∞ Image Link: Image of Three Forks

WEEK 9 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 9

Searching for the Shoshone; Ocean in View! Oh, the Joy!

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ INTRO

The reading will be broken up into two sections because we are skipping chapter 10. Do you remember what tribe Sacagawea is from? (Shoshone) When she was about 12 years old, she was captured by an enemy tribe, the Hidatsa, and later given to the French-Canadian trader, Charbonneau, who was living among the Hidatsa, as one of his wives. It had been about 5 years since she had seen her people.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Finish Ch.9 p.97-101 "The Indians crowded" - "the other explorers."
2. Chapter 10 talks about a very trying time for everyone as they entered the Rocky Mountains. The path was steep, there was little food, and it was cold and wet. After hiking more than 150 miles in eleven days, they made it over the Rocky Mountains. The men finally got some food from the Nez Perce Indians, but after not eating much for 11 days and then gorging on dried fish and berries, the men felt sick.
3. Begin Ch.11 p.115-119 "I don't know" - "eating dog meat."

WEEK 10 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 10

Ocean in View! Oh, the Joy!

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ INTRO

Eighty percent of the Corps of Discovery's round-trip journey was by water. Today, you will read about more of their journey over the rivers. They will have to decide whether they will portage their canoes or go through the rapids. What would you do? Take a look at this miniature replica of the dugout canoe that they rode in. Generally, the dugouts were about thirty feet long and up to three feet wide, and they held supplies and four to six men, who probably knelt to keep the center of gravity low and prevent tipping. Empty, each canoe may have weighed as much as a ton.

∞ Image Link: Dugout canoe

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Map of Expedition

After they pass the Nez Perce, what two rivers will they come across? [A: Snake and Columbia]

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.119-128 "By the time" - "O! the joy."

• DEFINITIONS

spawned: to produce or lay eggs in water (p.121)

U.S. History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 11 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 11

A Soggy Winter

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ INTRO

Do you remember what Captain Clark said at the end of the last chapter? "Ocean in view! O joy." They were actually in the Columbia River Estuary. Look at this aerial image of the Columbia River Estuary. Do you think it has fresh water or salt water? An estuary is a partially enclosed body of water where fresh water from rivers and streams mixes with salt water from the ocean. The resulting water is called brackish.

∞ Image Link: Aerial image of Columbia River Estuary

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.129-137 "The next day" - "but known distance."

Note: The rest of the chapter will not be assigned. You may want students to read it during exam week.

- Do you think a group vote is a good way to make a decision? Why or why not?
- Now the crew can head back home. What do you think they were looking forward to when they got back home?

WEEK 12 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

Seaman: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

U.S. History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 13

Blackfeet and Bad Luck

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

PREP: We are skipping chapter 13 for the sake of time. Students can always read it outside of lesson time.

→ RECAP

Where did we leave off?

→ INTRO

In chapter 13, the Corps of Discovery started heading home, but since it was early spring, the animals were not as plentiful. They also had to wait for the snow to melt before they could cross the Rocky Mountains. They were told about a shortcut that could take 80 miles off their homebound journey.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Begin Ch.14 p.159-167 "Seaman paced through" - "had led his party."

WEEK 2 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 14

End of the Expedition

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

→ NOTE

This reading is longer in order to finish the book. You may have to finish it outside of lesson time.

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.167-179 "On August 11" - "tail wagging eagerly."

- Do you remember the 3 main goals of the expedition (find a northwest passage, establish relationships with Native Americans, and learn about new plants and animals)? Did they accomplish their goals? (There was no direct water route to the west, but the other goals were accomplished.)
- How might the expedition have been different without Seaman?

→ VIEW

This statue can be found outside the Lewis and Clark Interpretative Center in Sioux City, Iowa.

∞ Image Link: Statue of Lewis, Clark & Seaman

• IMPORTANT DATES

1806 Lewis and Clark Expedition ends when they reach St. Louis

- ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, or crayons.

WEEK 3 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 15

The Mysterious Mr. Lincoln; A Backwoods Boy

Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography

→ INTRO

What do you know about Abraham Lincoln? There are more books written about Lincoln than any other American. This book is called a photobiography. How might photos help us understand a person from the past instead of just words? How might photos not give us a complete picture of the past?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

• DEFINITIONS

reticent: inclined to be silent or uncommunicative in speech (p.2)

yarns: stories (p.4)

emancipator: someone who frees others from bondage (p.5)

• IMPORTANT DATES

1809 Abraham Lincoln was born



Term 2

p.1-10 "Abraham Lincoln wasn't" - "beneath the roof."

- What are some initial impressions you have about Lincoln so far?
- Why do you think so many people didn't learn to read and write back then?

WEEK 4 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 16

A Backwoods Boy

Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography, US Atlas

→ RECAP

Tell briefly what you remember about Lincoln so far.

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: US Atlas

1. p.10-11 Lincoln lived in Indiana by the Ohio River and worked as a ferryman's helper. Find that on the map.
2. Then he was hired to take someone on a flatboat voyage on the Mississippi River. Trace the route from the Ohio River to the Mississippi River and follow it until it ends.
3. p.14-15 What city does the Mississippi River flow through before reaching the Gulf? [A: New Orleans]

→ INTRO

Do you have any ideas about how children on the frontier got their schooling? We will read about the kind of schooling Lincoln had.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.10-19 "Soon after the" - "were fast friends."

- What do you think about the way Lincoln got his education?
- How would you describe Lincoln's work ethic? Work ethic is a set of values centered on the importance of doing work, as seen through one's desire or determination to work hard.

WEEK 5 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 17

A Backwoods Boy; Law and Politics

Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography

→ RECAP

Tell briefly what you remember about Lincoln so far.

→ LOCATE

Map Link: Places where Lincoln lived

1. Near what town was Lincoln born in Kentucky? [A: Hodgenville]
2. Where in Indiana did they move when he was a boy? [A: Spencer County]
3. When he was 21, they set off for what town in Illinois? [A: Decatur]
4. At 22, he then moved away from his family to work at a general store in what town? [A: New Salem]
5. When Lincoln becomes a lawyer and is elected to a second term for the state legislature, he moves to the state capital of Illinois. What is the name of that city? [A: Springfield]

→ INTRO

If you wanted to learn something new and couldn't ask an adult to teach you, how would you go about doing that? There were a lot of things that Lincoln didn't know about, but that didn't stop him from learning all about them. We will read more about the topics he studied in today's reading.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

• DEFINITIONS

melancholy: a sad mood or feeling (p.27)

U.S. History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

p.19-28 "Lincoln also found" - "just good friends."

- What are your impressions now about Lincoln?
- How has he changed from the boy who lived in the backwoods to the lawyer and state representative? How has he not changed?

WEEK 6 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 18

Law and Politics

Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

Do you know the two major political parties in the US? (Republican and Democrat) During this time, the Democrats and the Whigs were the two major parties, although in 1854, most northern Whigs joined the newly formed Republican Party. That was the party of Lincoln. The Whigs used the same name as the English political party that opposed absolute monarchy.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.28-37 "While Lincoln was" - "knees beside him."

- No one's life is perfect, and Lincoln had his share of hardships and disappointments in his personal life and in his political career. How does he seem to handle these pressures?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL IF THERE IS TIME)

This chapter talked about Lincoln's opposition to the Mexican War. This short video is helpful in explaining the war and how America expanded at that time.

∞ Video Link: How the Mexican-American War changed the US forever

• DEFINITIONS

temperamental: marked by excessive sensitivity and impulsive mood changes (p.28)

WEEK 7 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 19

Half Slave and Half Free

Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.37-48 "Lincoln was at" - "way of life."

- How would you describe Lincoln as a family man?
- What characteristics of Lincoln made him a good lawyer?

• DEFINITIONS

propriety: conformity to what is socially acceptable in conduct or speech, proper (p.41)

WEEK 8 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 20

Half Slave and Half Free

Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography

→ NOTE

Some of the concepts discussed in this chapter might be a little advanced for some students. Obviously, they don't need to understand every aspect of the debates between Lincoln and Douglas. It is important to understand the main idea they were debating, which is mentioned in the introduction below, and then have some understanding of the differing views. You can stop often to have them narrate and even write some of the arguments on a whiteboard, showing the different sides. The debates will also be part of the next lesson.

U.S. History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Map of US in 1854

1. Look at the map key. What does orange mean? What does green mean?
2. Where are most of the states that allow slavery located? Why do you think that is the case?

→ INTRO

Here is the issue that the government was discussing: Would each new state enter as a free state or a slave state? A new act passed by Congress (the Kansas-Nebraska Act) said that the people in each new state would decide what to do about slavery. That means that slavery might continue to spread. Lincoln could sit back no longer. He now felt compelled to do what he could to oppose the spread of slavery. He went back into politics to win a Senate seat and engaged in seven public debates with a man named Stephen Douglas. These events were like a modern-day sporting event and were attended by thousands of people.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.50-59 "The issue came" - "into the air."

- What does it say about the character of Lincoln that he was willing to go back into politics and to argue so strongly against slavery?

WEEK 9 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 21

Half Slave and Half Free; Emancipation

📖 Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time? Do you remember some of the differences between Lincoln and Douglas?

→ INTRO

Now you will read about the debates that were all held in different small towns in Illinois in the summer of 1858. What do you think makes someone a good debater? Then you will see how those debates brought Lincoln into the spotlight.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.59-68 "The give and take" - "compromise had failed."

- What do you think were Lincoln's strongest points of argument against Douglas?
- When Lincoln took his oath of office, what kind of country was he leading?

• DEFINITIONS

popular sovereignty: the theory that government is created by and subject to the will of the people. In this case, the people could vote on whether a state should be free or allow slavery. (p.59)

secede: to separate from a nation or state and become independent (p.65)

howitzer: a large gun that is used to fire shells high into the air for a short distance (p.67)

WEEK 10 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 22

Emancipation

📖 Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

The worst came true—the nation was in a civil war. A civil war is when citizens of the same country fight each other. More people died in the Civil War than in any other war that America has been a part of. Most people thought the war would end quickly. The North had a larger

U.S. History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

population, factories to produce ammunition and guns, and better means of transportation. However, the South had more military leaders and military talent. The war lasted 4 long years.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.68-79 "He traveled east" - "on Tad's bed."

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL IF YOU HAVE TIME)

This 4-minute video does a good job of explaining why the "Union" was so important to the people and why it was worth fighting for. NOTE: At around 2:12, there is an illustration of a scantily clad woman on the battlefield representing Lady Liberty.

∞ Video Link: What was the Union?

WEEK 11 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 23

This Dreadful War

📖 Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography

PREP: There is one more week of this book in Term 3, which tells about Lincoln's assassination. We are skipping most of chapter 6, which is about the war, for the sake of time and due to the graphic details in the chapter. You may want to read parts of it with your student during exam week. Otherwise, there will be a couple of paragraphs read in lesson 25 before we finish the book. There is also an article you can read or listen to that talks about some of the major battles of the war.

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

Just when Lincoln was facing such difficulty as the President during the Civil War, he would face a personal tragedy as well. But even in his grief, Lincoln had to press on and make big decisions. What should leaders consider before making important choices?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.80-91 "Lincoln took the" - "for this act."

★ TEACHER NOTE

Please preview the photo on p.88 and decide how you want to handle that with sensitive children.

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Article Link: Important Battles of the Civil War

WEEK 12 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

Lincoln: A Photobiography



Term 3

WEEK 1 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 25

Who Is Dead in the White House?

Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography

→ RECAP

Where did we leave off in this book?

→ INTRO

We are skipping most of chapter 6 about the battles of the war. We will read the last couple of pages of the chapter that talk about Lincoln's reelection and the end of the war. The second part of today's reading discusses the tragic end of Lincoln's life.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.112-130 "Union victories had" - "does not falter."

- What lessons can modern readers learn from Lincoln's life?
- Why do you think more books are written about Lincoln than any other American?

WEEK 2 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 26

Declaration of Independence; Slavery

Materials: Heart and Soul

→ INTRO

This book tells about what life was like for African Americans during this time period, who were brought to the United States against their will to become slaves. The first chapter will go back to the time during the Revolutionary War when America was fighting for its independence from Britain. It is told in the voice of a grandmother telling her grandchild the story of the trials and courage of African Americans through the centuries.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1-2 p.9-21

- Why was it impossible for slaves to fight back against those who captured them or against their masters?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: US Capitol Building

∞ Image Link: Inside the Rotunda

WEEK 3 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 27

Abolition; Lincoln's War

Materials: Heart and Soul

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.3-4 p.23-37

- Why was learning to read and write such a powerful weapon and, therefore, illegal for slaves?
- Is there anything you read in this retelling of the Civil War that gave a different perspective than what you remember from Lincoln's biography?

U.S. History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 4 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 28

Reconstruction; Cowboys and Indians

Materials: Heart and Soul

→ INTRO

The slaves were set free, but now what would they do and where would they live? What kind of issues would need to be addressed now that the war is over?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5-6 p.39-51

- What new opportunities did African Americans have after the war, and in what ways was it still very hard?

WEEK 5 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 29

Frontier Photographers; Going West

Materials: Children of the Wild West

→ INTRO

How do historians write books about the past? They look at primary sources such as letters, documents, and photographs from the time period to try to understand what life was like. In this book, you will be able to see actual photographs from the 1800s to learn about what life was like for children who moved with their families to the western part of the United States. If you could ask children from back then any questions about their lives, what might you ask them?

→ LOCATE

Trace the route of the Oregon Trail. Where does it begin? [A: Independence, Missouri] In today's reading, you will read about a family that has made it to the North Platte River, which is now part of current-day Wyoming. Find that on the map.
∞ Map Link: Map of Oregon Trail

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.9-18 "On May 19" - "a foreign land."

- Do you think the photographs captured the personality of the people since they had to stand still and not move at all (or the picture would be blurred)?

→ VIEW

Take time to look at the photographs. What do you think it would be like traveling in the covered wagons?

• IMPORTANT DATES

1841 First pioneers set out from Missouri to head west

• EXTRA HELPING

Watch this video to learn more about the first transcontinental railroad mentioned on p.17.

∞ Video Link: Transcontinental Railroad

WEEK 6 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 30

Going West; Settling Down

Materials: Children of the Wild West

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

When people talk about the Oregon Trail, they are mostly referring to a pair of wheel ruts cutting across the prairie grass. Follow the trail on p.19. What rivers and geographical features do you see along the Oregon Trail?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

• DEFINITIONS

ford: to cross (a body of water) by walking through it (p.18)

bureau: dresser (p.21)

cholera: a serious disease that causes severe vomiting and diarrhea and that often results in death (p.23)

typhoid: a serious disease that is passed from one person to another in dirty food or water



Term 3

p.18-30 "Their journey started" - "50,000 by 1855."

- What do you think would be the hardest part about traveling out west?
- Why do you think people were so determined to do it despite the hardships?

→ VIEW

1. Look at the log cabin on p.27. How did they use natural resources for all aspects of the cabin, inside and out?
 2. (Optional) Watch this short video about the Gold Rush in California. (Can stop at 1:40)
- ∞ Video Link: The Gold Rush

(p.23)

• EXTRA HELPING

Watch this video to learn more about log cabins.

∞ Video Link: Pioneer Life in a Log Cabin

WEEK 7 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 31

Settling Down

📄 Materials: Children of the Wild West

→ RECAP

Briefly talk about the previous reading.

→ INTRO

You read about the log cabins that were built by the pioneers. What kind of houses do you think families built if they lived in the prairies, where there were not a lot of trees? You will read about the kinds of houses they built and see if you would like that kind of house.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.30-40 "So far, the" - "from their own."

- What do you think about the soddies? Would you want to live in one?
- How have homes changed since these early days?

→ VIEW

Look at the picture on p.35. List any observations you have about Main Street of Granite, Oklahoma. How is it different from your town?

• DEFINITIONS

cheesecloth: a thin, gauzy cotton fabric with a loose weave. It was first used in cheesemaking but has many other kitchen functions. (p.33)

• IMPORTANT DATES

1862 Congress passes the Homestead Act

WEEK 8 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 32

The American Indians

📄 Materials: Children of the Wild West

→ RECAP

Briefly talk about the previous reading.

→ INTRO

The American West was hardly an empty wilderness. Hundreds of thousands of Indians still lived west of the Mississippi River at this time. We will learn what life was like for Native Americans and their children at that time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.39-57 "The Oregon Trail" - end of chapter.

- What might be similar about Native American children and your life, and what is different?

→ VIEW

1. Look at the pictures of the various dwellings of the tribes. How are their homes different from one another?
2. Look at the children on p.54 and p.56 when they arrived at the boarding schools and then a year or so later on p.55 and p.57. What are the differences? Why do you think the government wanted to put Indian



Term 3

children in these schools? What do you think the children and parents thought about it?

3. (Optional) This video tells about the Trail of Tears, when 60,000 Native Americans were forced to relocate to a reservation.

∞ Video Link: Trail of Tears (3:00)

WEEK 9 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 33

Frontier Schools

Materials: Children of the Wild West

→ INTRO

If you were a teacher at a one-room schoolhouse with students ranging in age from seven to sixteen, what subjects would you teach, and how would you go about teaching and managing a classroom in that kind of environment?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.59-69 "I remember the" - "to be trouble."

- What stands out to you about the frontier schools? How would you solve some of the issues they had to deal with?

→ VIEW

Look at the images in this chapter and talk about what was different about schooling back then.

WEEK 10 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 34

Building the West

Materials: Children of the Wild West

→ INTRO

What kind of chores do you have around your house? You will read about the chores that frontier children were responsible for since they had no modern conveniences.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.71-81 "At a frontier" - "any gold miner."

- What chores do you think you would have enjoyed if you lived in those days? Which ones would you have disliked?
- Why do you think variety shows and circuses were a popular thing at that time?

→ VIEW

Look at the photographs in this chapter and talk about the various chores and jobs.

WEEK 11 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 35

Games, Parties, and Celebrations

Materials: Children of the Wild West

→ INTRO

Life on the frontier wasn't all work. There was time for play and fun! You may be surprised to read about all the activities and celebrations that were part of the children's lives.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.83-94 "When pioneer children" - "filled with patriotism?"

- If you could ask pioneer children any questions about their lives, what

- **ILLUSTRATE** - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, or crayons.

U.S. History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3	
would you ask them? ● If someone took a photo of you to put in a book for students to read in 100 years or so to see what life was like in 2026, what would you do in the photo?	
WEEK 12 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 36 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Children of the Wild West	

U.S. History: Grades 4-6

Examination

Term 1

· SeaMan: Tell you know about the Lewis and Clark Expedition and how SeaMan brought them companionship.

Term 2

· Lincoln-A Photobiography: Tell all you know about the life of Abraham Lincoln and how he helped to end slavery.

Term 3

· Children of the Wild West: Tell all you know about what daily life was like for the children of pioneers and how their lives were different from yours.